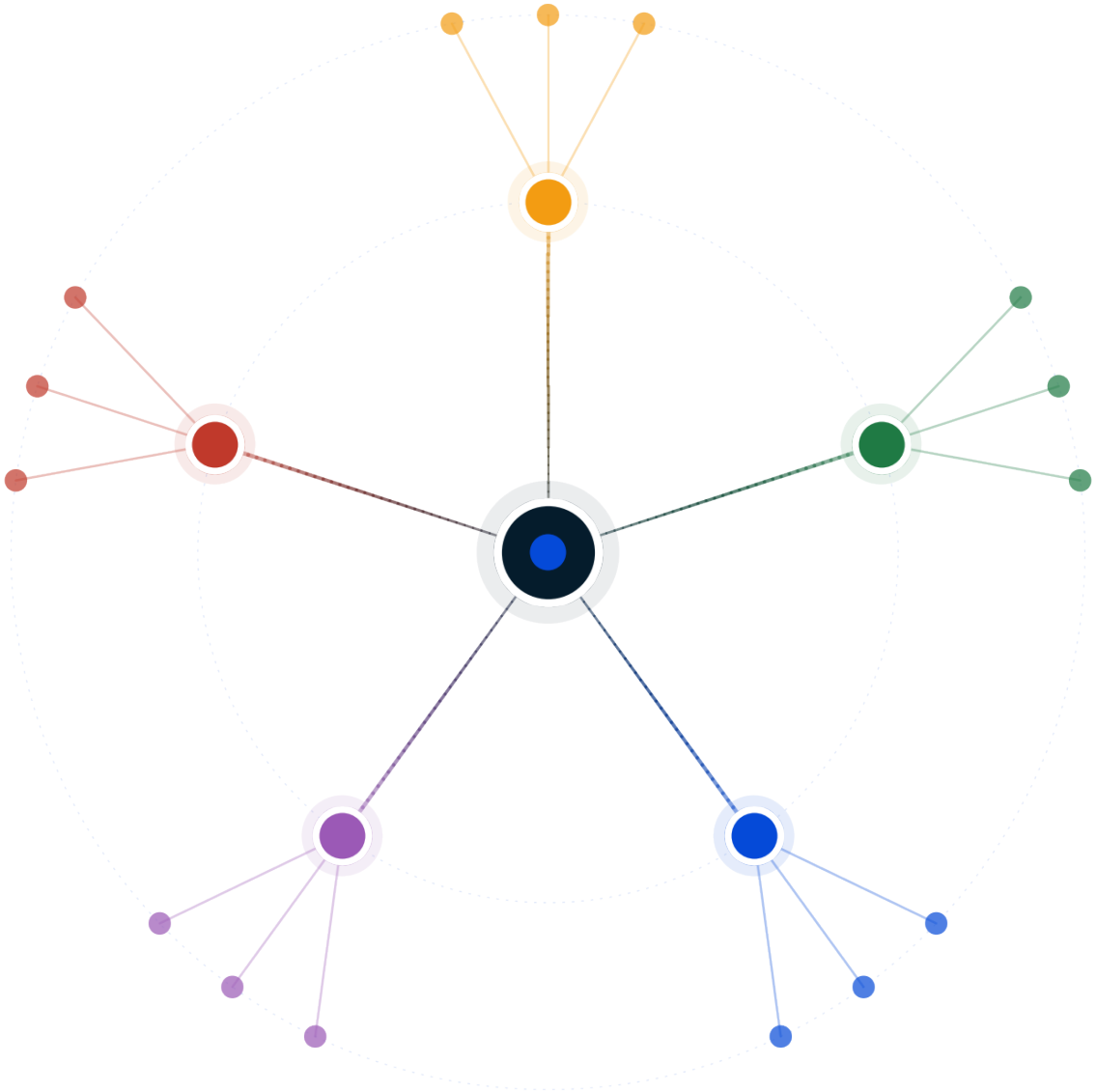
Autodecision

Should I drop B2B SaaS pricing by 10%?



Quick Decision Brief — single-pass analysis, no council

April 2026

GENERATED BY AUTODECISION — possibility map with synthesized recommendation, not a single-shot answer

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Do not implement a blanket 10% cut; restructure to hybrid pricing or test segmented promo instead

DO NOT cut blanket pricing 10%. Cut is too small to move enterprise (inelastic), too large to ignore in margin (3-7 pts compression), and 60%+ likely to be matched by competitors within 90 days. Instead: (a) segmented SMB-only promotional tier, (b) usage-based or hybrid component giving lower entry without permanent anchor reset, or (c) time-limited 10%

CONFIDENCE

LOW-MEDIUM · single pass, no adversarial pressure · run / autodecision for full council + iteration on a high-stakes pricing call

DEPENDS ON

Price elasticity in target segment >1 [G1] · Competitors don't match within 90 days [G3] · Cut applies uniformly · Sales team doesn't stack additional discounts · Existing customers don't discover and demand parity

MONITOR

ARPU on new deals · Existing customer renewal demands · SMB vs enterprise acquisition split · Competitor pricing pages · Sales discount stacking · Gross margin trend

PRE-MORTEM

Competitor matches within 90 days (P=0.60) · Sales team uses cut as crutch (P=0.50) · Existing customers demand renegotiation (P=0.70) · Margin compresses 3-7 points (P=0.85)

DOMINANT RISK

Enterprise inelasticity — 3x less price-sensitive than SMB [G1]. A 10% cut lands in the dead zone: too small to change vendor selection, large enough to compress margins materially.

BETTER ALTERNATIVE

Hybrid / usage-based pricing — Chargebee data [G6] shows 38% higher revenue growth premium · 43% of SaaS already hybrid · Gartner predicts 70% prefer usage by 2026 [G7]

Source: Quick Decision Brief (single-pass) · [G1], [G3], [G6], [G7]

PART 2

How we explored this decision

Quick-mode single-pass against grounded data — what did the analysis surface?

Quick-mode single-pass analysis with 4 hypotheses, 12 effects, 5 sensitivity assumptions

- Mode: Quick (single-pass, no council, no iteration, no adversarial pressure) — fast sanity check before a real decision, not a final answer
- 4 hypotheses generated — including the 'restructure pricing instead of cut' alternative that scored highest
- 12 effects mapped (7 first-order + 5 second-order) with probability + timeframe per effect
- 5 key assumptions ranked by sensitivity — 2 HIGH, 2 MEDIUM, 1 LOW
- Real-world anchors: enterprise B2B price elasticity 3x lower than SMB [G1], competitor match rate 60%+ [G3], hybrid pricing 38% revenue premium [G6]
- Confidence is bounded LOW-MEDIUM by design — for high-stakes pricing changes, run /autodecision for full council + iteration

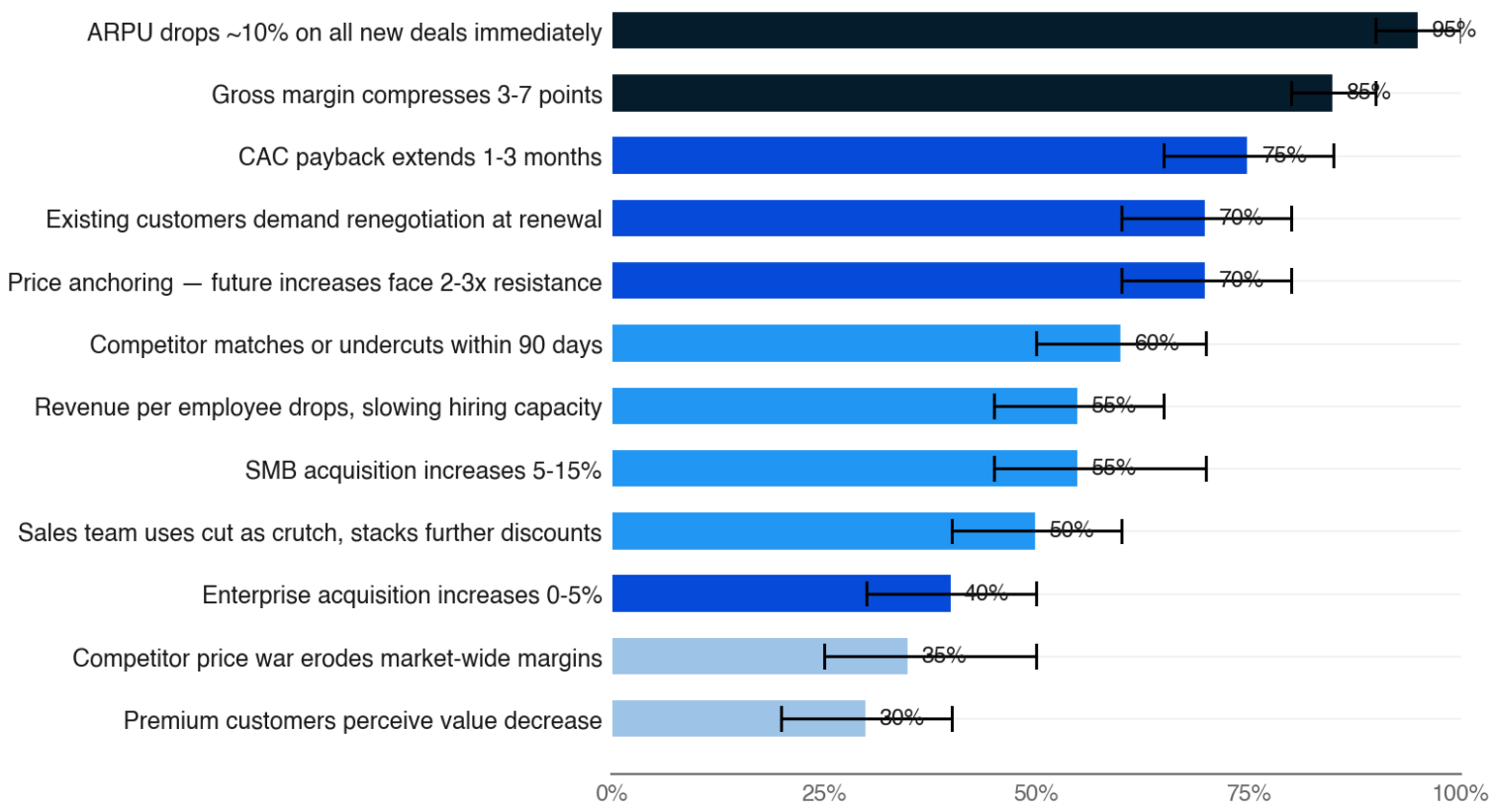
Source: Quick Decision Brief — Effects + Key Assumptions

Four hypotheses; only 'restructure to hybrid' survives the basic stress-test

#	Hypothesis	Status	Why
1	10% cut drives enough volume to offset revenue loss	Unlikely	Enterprise inelastic; only plausible in SMB segment
2	10% cut triggers competitor matching; net-zero benefit	Likely	60%+ match rate per [G3]; erodes market margins
3	10% cut is too small to matter (dead zone)	Likely	Doesn't shift vendor selection; does compress margins
4	Restructure pricing model (hybrid/usage-based) instead	Recommended	Hybrid models +38% revenue growth [G6]; addresses growth without permanent cut

Source: Quick Decision Brief — Hypotheses

Strongest signals: ARPU drop is certain; volume lift is segment-specific; competitor match is likely



- Top 12 effects ranked by probability × council-style agreement (single-pass: agreement is heuristic)
- Bar color = agreement weight (navy = strong evidence, fading to pale = single-source)
- Black bracket = uncertainty range — wider bars mean less confidence
- Three highest-P effects (ARPU drop, margin compression, CAC extension) are the cost side — all near-certain
- Volume lift effects (SMB +5-15%, enterprise +0-5%) skew low — the cut is too small to move the needle

Source: Quick Decision Brief — Effects (first + second order) · [G1], [G3], [G6]

Selected sources

Tags appear inline throughout the deck — [G#] = ground data (synthesized from Data Foundation table; quick-mode briefs predate ## Sources schema)

Tag	Type	Claim	Source
G1	Ground	Enterprise vs SMB price elasticity gap — up to 3x less sensitive in enterprise	Monetizely B2B SaaS elasticity research
G2	Ground	Cross-segment elasticity variation — 2-4x across B2B SaaS segments	Monetizely measurement guide
G3	Ground	Competitor price-matching rate — 60%+ of businesses respond to competitor price moves	Maxio, Cobloom SaaS pricing research
G4	Ground	High-ARPU churn advantage — customers >$250/mo have lowest churn rates	Vitally, Churnfree benchmarks
G5	Ground	Value-based pricing premium — outperforms cost-plus and competitor-based by 30-40%	Cobloom, Dock pricing strategy research
G6	Ground	Hybrid pricing revenue lift — 38% higher revenue growth vs single-model	Chargebee State of Subscriptions 2025
G7	Ground	Usage-based pricing adoption — 43% SaaS hybrid; Gartner predicts 70% prefer usage by 2026	Chargebee, Gartner

Source: Quick Decision Brief — Data Foundation table (synthesized into [G#] tags)